

The Gentlemen

Threat Assessment & Strategy

OmniRoute Logistics

Cyber Preparedness Task Force

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🕒 Agenda - Roadmap

1 Adversary Overview

Who are the gentlemen, RaaS model, and why OmniRoute fits

2 Adversary Profile

Classification, persistence methods, and encryption techniques

3 Consequences

Mapping adversary goals to organizational impact, severity matrix, and broad level risks

4 Preparedness

Cyber Attack Lifecycle Mapping, IR and Architectural Resilience

5 Detection

OriginalFileName detection logic, triage walkthrough, and closing the EID coverage gap

6 Priority Recommendations

Long term(90 days) strategy, emergency action items, and funding for critical defences

🎯 Threat Landscape



WHO ARE THEY?

- Raas operation active since mid-2025
- 402 victims across 70 countries
- Rebrand of Eastern European operators
- Dual Extortion model - exfiltration + Encryption
- Platform



WHY OMNIROUTE?

- Fortigate infrastructure: CVE-2024-55591 focus
- Record Volume: 600k records/day
- Logistics and Business Service sectors among top affected sectors
- High profile clients(Healthcare/ Gov)



URGENT: Emergency audit of all Fortigate appliances against CVE-2024-55591 IS REQUIRED BY THIS WEEK

🕒 Origin and Scale: The Gentlemen



Emerged mid-2025

Technically sophisticated cyber crime group that has fast risen to become the number two ransomware group in the short period of operation



Global Scale

402 victims across 73 countries globally as of May 2026.



Sectors

Targeting multiple sectors majorly in Manufacturing, Technology, Business Services, Healthcare and Consumer Services.



RaaS model

Technically sophisticated cyber crime group with an attractive 90/10 revenue split fueling a growing affiliate network.



● Adversary Classification

CLASS: Cyber Breach & Organizational Disruption

Financially Motivated

Primarily financially motivated. the group employs double extortion.

Technically Capable and Mature

the group uses advanced TTPs to breach, encrypt and exfiltrate data from victims

🕒 Cyber Attack Lifecycle

Recon



Initial Access



Discovery



Privilege
Escalation



Lateral
Movement



Persistence



Defense
Evasion



Execution



Exfiltration



Impact

🕒 Organizational Consequences

Area	Severity Rating	Justification
Financial	Severe	Ransom + Regulatory fines + Client and shareholder lawsuits
Operational	Severe	600k records/day; 3 week estimate recovery time
Reputational	Severe	Loss of client and regulatory trust; Permanent TOR publication
Regulatory	High	Multiple regulatory frameworks compliance requirements as a result of operating in 42 countries and 4 continents with high profile client base including governments and healthcare

● Preparedness

Current Preparedness Posture: **Basic Hygiene**

Insufficient protection:

- Unreliable vulnerability management across the entire infrastructure
- Endpoint only solutions that are insufficient against The Gentlemen tactics such as BYOVD capability

● Preparedness

Recommended Preparedness Posture: **Architectural Resilience**

Root Causes consideration:

- Network micro-segmentation to limit lateral movement and therefore blast radius
- Immutable air-gapped backups to ensure recovery
- Employing principle of least privilege at network level to eliminate privilege escalation paths even when EDRs are disabled

● Detection

EID 1: Use of OriginalFileName Over Image to Detect Renamed Binaries

Sysmon EID 1 ProcessCreation uses the embedded PE header (OriginalFileName) instead of Image which shows a changeable filename path at runtime.

The Gentlemen rename the filename from schtasks.exe to updater.exe to evade detection after abusing task scheduler(schtasks.exe) for persistence

● Detection

Triage Fields

Command Line: Full command string used to schedule task

User: User account that ran the process

Image: Filepath where the binary is executing from

Privilege Level: Privilege level at which the task is running

● Detection

EID 11: File Creation GAP

The Blind Spot

EID 1 only detects schtasks.exe execution.

The Gentlemen can create scheduled tasks through:

- PowerShell
- WMI (T1047)
- COM API

No schtasks.exe launched

EID 1 sees nothing

● Detection

EID 11: File Creation Gap

The EID 11 Solution

EID 11 monitors the task XML file creation directly.

Even if attackers bypass process monitoring, the persistence artifact is still detected.

🕒 Priority Recommendations

Critical (0 - 72 hrs)

- CVE-2024-55591 patch across all Fortigate appliances
- Enforce MFA across all VPN endpoints
- Rotate all VPN and Fortigate administrative credentials
- Configure Fortigate IPS for CVE-2024-55591 detection

🕒 Priority Recommendations

High (0 - 30 days)

- Deploy Sysmon via Group Policy across all windows domain-joined endpoints
- Implement network micro-segmentation
- Run Incident Response exercises for The gentleman specific scenario
- Activate commercial threat intelligence platform integrated with IOC feeds into SIEM

🕒 Priority Recommendations

Medium (30 - 90 days)

- Deploy and test immutable air-gapped backups
- Develop and legally review breach notification procedures
- Establish external coordination contacts such as with Interpol
- Deploy Sysmon on all endpoints and integrate with SIEM

● Priority Recommendations

Strategic (90+ days)

- Conduct The Gentlemen based red team exercises on patched and hardened environments
- Implement continuous vulnerability management
- Commission zero-trust network access architecture reviews for all three data centers

● Open Risks & Assumptions

- Unknown patch status of CVE-2024-55591 across the entire organization's infrastructure. It should be assumed that the attacker has already infiltrated the system
- VPN Credentials already on the dark web
- IR playbook will work despite chaos during an active incident



conclusion

The Gentlemen ransomware group represents a major threat to OmniRoute Logistics because of its advanced ransomware capabilities and use of FortiGate vulnerabilities.

The assessment identified several weaknesses in the company's governance, operations, and technical architecture. Without stronger resilience measures, OmniRoute faces the risk of operational shutdown, data loss, and regulatory consequences. The company should prioritize architectural resilience, stronger detection engineering, and improved incident response capabilities to ensure survival and continuity following an attack.



thank you